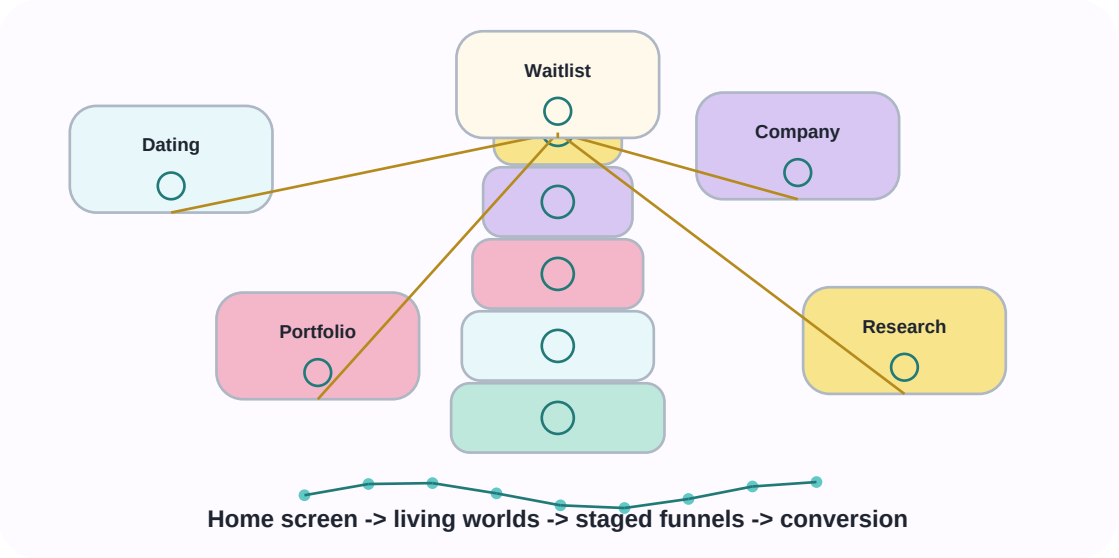
Portal Machine Story Maps

Business idea and web app blueprint for living-world link funnels, kinetic narrative architecture, and automated causeway pages.



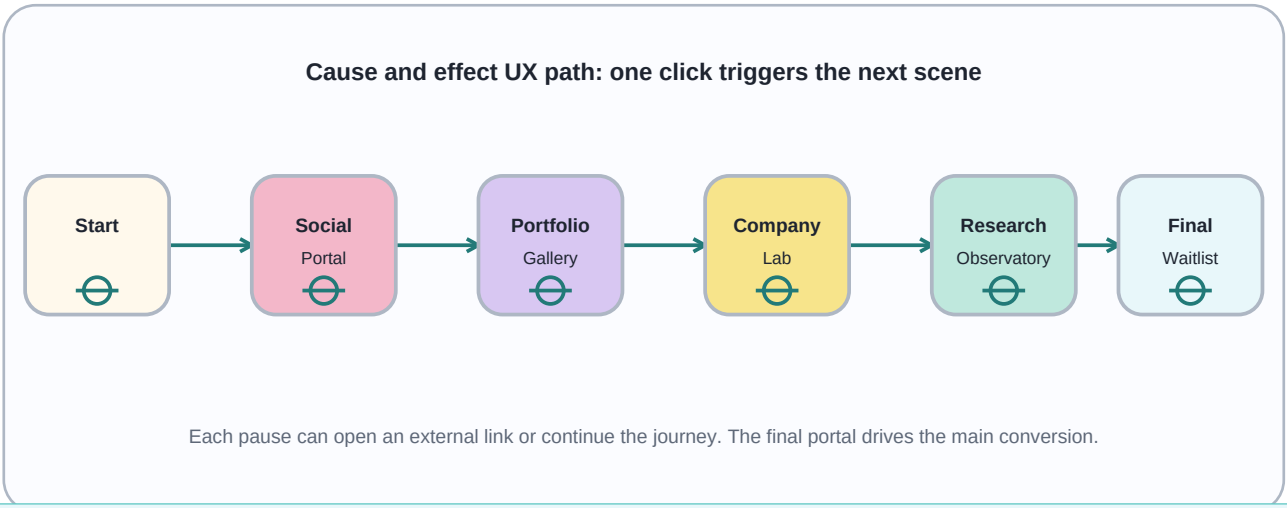
Prepared for: Kendren Cornish | **Brand example:** Kindred's Waitlist | **Draft:** v1

The core idea: turn a simple link-in-bio page into a stationary app home screen where every icon opens a living portal-machine world. Each world guides users through a visual chain reaction, pauses at strategic offers, then drives them into a final conversion.

1. Executive Summary

Portal Machine Story Maps is a web app concept that combines a link-tree, a cinematic landing page, and an interactive illustrated funnel. Instead of showing a list of boring links, the visitor enters a home screen of branded applications. Each application opens into its own living world: a kinetic, hand-drawn story map where each movement causes the next action.

The product can be used for a personal brand, entrepreneur portfolio, restaurant, research archive, company ecosystem, dating/social project, event funnel, creator page, or startup waitlist. The backend can stay simple: each application contains a set of stops, buttons, links, forms, and automations. The frontend makes it feel premium, magical, and alive.



This is not just a website aesthetic. It is a repeatable funnel mechanic: select app -> enter world -> pause at stops -> click external destinations or continue -> final CTA.

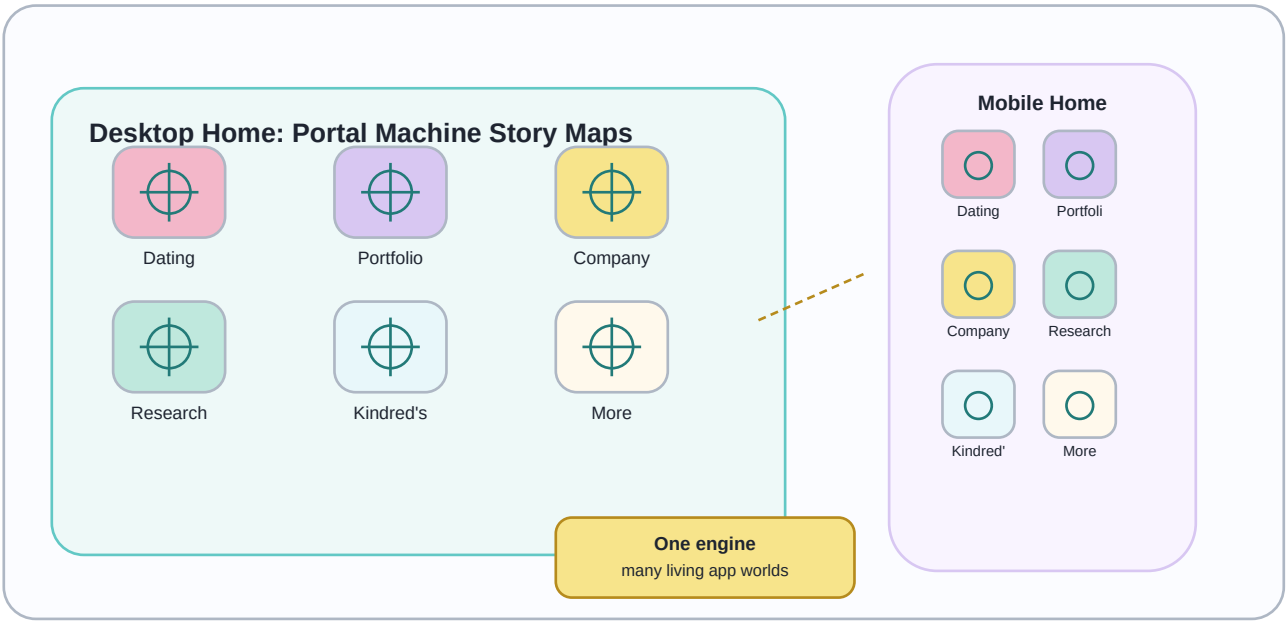
2. Core Language and Positioning

Term	Meaning	Use in the product
Portal Machine Story Map	A branded illustrated page that behaves like a living machine.	Each app opens one story map.
Kinetic Narrative Architecture	Rooms, paths, triggers, and scenes arranged to create a story-driven user journey.	The design language behind every world.
Domino System Illustration	A visible chain reaction where one motion causes the next.	The interaction logic of the funnel.
Causeway World	A themed living world created for one business, creator, project, or campaign.	The sellable unit or template.
Living App	An icon on the main home screen that expands into a world.	The user-facing entry point.
Final Portal	The final conversion chamber after the user passes through the stops.	Waitlist, booking, purchase, newsletter, or application.

Positioning sentence: Portal Machine Story Maps turn a link page into a living world that tells the story, routes the visitor, and converts attention into action.

3. Product Model

The product has two main layers: a stationary home screen and a set of animated living worlds. On desktop, the home screen feels like a clean computer desktop. On mobile, it feels like a phone home screen. The user sees a grid of applications. Each application is a portal into a different funnel.



Each application can use the same underlying engine while carrying a different brand, visual theme, set of stops, and final conversion goal.

- **Main home screen:** stationary, simple, branded, fast to load.
- **Application icons:** each icon represents one living world and one business function.
- **World launcher:** opens the selected causeway world with a Start button.
- **Story stops:** pause points with buttons, links, descriptions, forms, or chatbot actions.
- **Final portal:** the main action - join waitlist, book call, order, view offer, apply, subscribe, or contact.

4. UX Mechanics: The Chain Reaction Funnel

The UX should feel like a Rube Goldberg machine, but the build should remain manageable for one developer. The visual complexity can live inside artwork, SVG layers, or simple animated components. The actual logic is a clean sequence of states.

Step	What happens visually	What happens strategically
1. Start	Visitor clicks Enter the World or an app icon. A lever, gear, marble, bridge, or portal activates.	Hooks attention and turns passive browsing into participation.
2. Movement	Camera pans or the path animates to the first room.	Creates curiosity and lowers bounce rate.
3. Pause Stop	Animation pauses at a room with a label, short pitch, and button.	Gives the visitor a choice: click link or continue.
4. Repeat	The next cause-and-effect action opens the next room.	Builds story momentum without overwhelming the visitor.
5. Final Portal	A glowing portal, door, elevator, tunnel, or launch chamber opens.	Focuses all attention on the main conversion.

Important: the backend can be simple JSON. The frontend sells the fantasy. The user does not need to understand the backend - they only experience movement, story, options, and conversion.

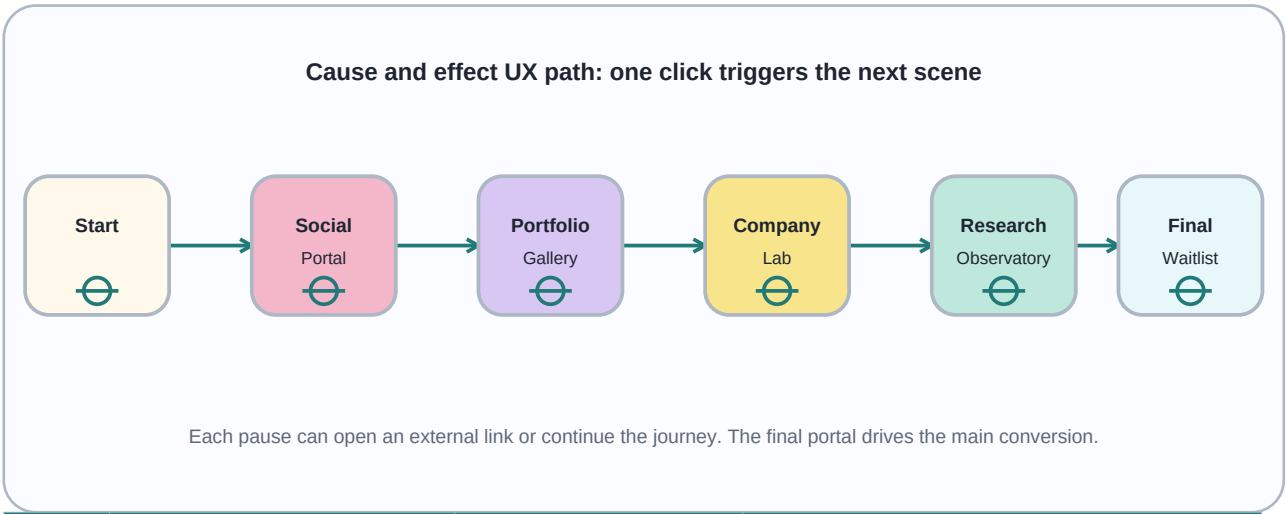
5. Living World Templates and Client Use Cases

Template	Example Stops	Final Goal
Kindred's Waitlist	Dating/Social Portal, Portfolio Gallery, Company Lab, Research Observatory	Join the waitlist or early access list.
Entrepreneur Portfolio	Origin Story, Work Samples, Offers, Case Studies	Book a call, download media kit, or contact.
Restaurant Portal	Menu Room, Reservation Desk, Delivery Dock, Chatbot Kitchen	Order, reserve, join loyalty list, or contact.
Creator Link Hub	Videos, Shop, Newsletter, Community, Events	Subscribe, buy, join community, or follow.
Research Archive	Papers, Notes, Experiments, Tools, Resource Library	Enter archive, subscribe, or request access.
Real Estate / Local Services	Listings, Services, Testimonials, Booking Desk	Lead form, tour request, quote request, or call.

The sellable promise: Instead of sending people to a dead list of links, give them a living map of your brand that routes them to the right action.

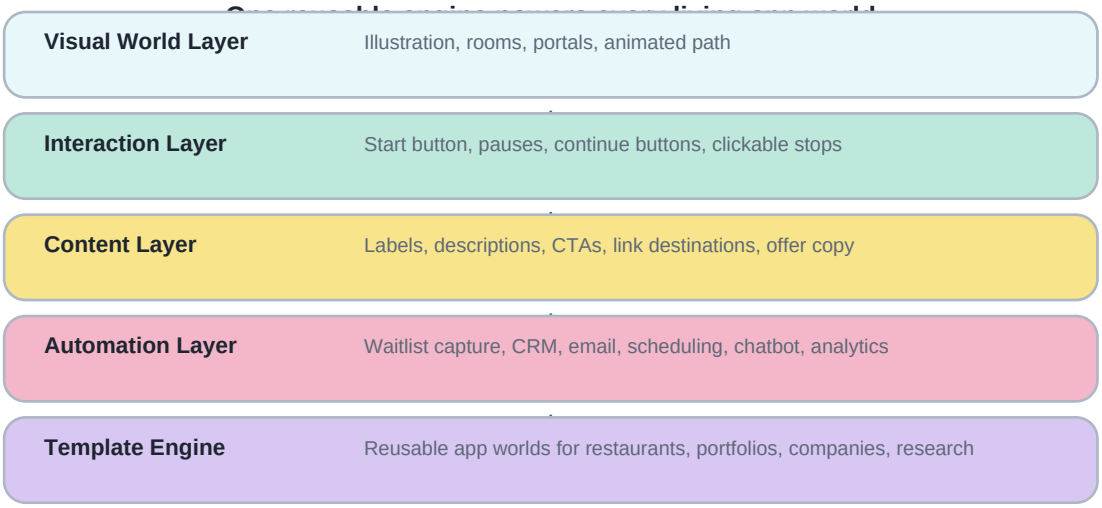
6. Example World: Kindred's Waitlist

Kindred's Waitlist is the first branded example. It acts like one application inside the larger Portal Machine Story Maps home screen. When clicked, it opens a story-world that presents multiple parts of the brand before leading to the final waitlist.



Stop	Label	Placeholder Link	CTA Copy
1	Social Portal	#dating-link	Enter the social experiment
2	Portfolio Gallery	#portfolio-link	View the creative archive
3	Company Lab	#company-link	Explore the systems being built
4	Research Observatory	#research-link	Open the research notes
5	Final Waitlist Portal	#waitlist-link	Join Kindred's Waitlist

7. Web App Architecture



The best MVP structure is a reusable template engine. Each living app world is powered by data, not custom code from scratch. That makes the product easier to sell, clone, customize, and maintain.

Suggested data model:

- **App:** title, icon, theme, slug, active status, owner/client.
- **World:** background art, animation path, scene order, sound setting, reduced-motion fallback.
- **Stop:** title, description, CTA label, link, form type, animation trigger, analytics event name.
- **Lead:** name, email, phone optional, source app, selected stop, final CTA, timestamp.
- **Asset:** SVG layers, background art, icons, room graphics, portal animation, copy blocks.
- **Analytics Event:** app opened, start clicked, stop viewed, link clicked, continue clicked, waitlist submitted.

8. MVP Scope for One Developer

The first version should avoid overbuilding. The goal is to prove the experience, capture leads, and show that different clients can have different living worlds from the same engine.

Phase	Build	Outcome
MVP 1	Stationary home screen with 5-6 app icons. One animated world for Kindred's Waitlist.	Proof of concept and shareable demo.
MVP 2	Reusable JSON-driven stop system, placeholder links, waitlist form, analytics events.	Turns the artwork into a true funnel engine.
MVP 3	Template presets for portfolio, restaurant, company, research, creator, event.	Makes the concept sellable to other people.
MVP 4	Light admin panel to edit labels, links, descriptions, images, and CTA buttons.	Client customization without developer edits.

Recommended stack: Next.js or React, Framer Motion or GSAP, SVG/Lottie animation layers, Supabase or Firebase for leads, Vercel for hosting, Resend/Mailchimp for email, Calendly for booking, and simple external payment/link placeholders when needed.

9. Business Model

Portal Machine Story Maps can start as a personal branded waitlist page, then evolve into a service and eventually a productized SaaS. The first money can come from custom builds, not software subscriptions.

- **Custom build package:** one branded living-world funnel for a creator, entrepreneur, restaurant, or local business.
- **Monthly management:** update links, offers, menus, campaigns, chatbot prompts, and analytics reports.
- **Template marketplace:** sell preset worlds such as Restaurant Portal, Portfolio Gallery, Research Observatory, and Company Lab.
- **Lead capture tier:** charge for waitlist collection, booking flows, newsletter integration, and CRM handoff.
- **White-label option:** agencies can use the engine for their own clients while you provide the template system.
- **Premium art package:** custom illustrated worlds, icons, and portal animations sold as upgrades.

Simple offer ladder:

Tier	What it includes
Starter	Interactive link hub with 4 stops and 1 final CTA.
Growth	Custom art direction, analytics, email capture, and 2-3 app worlds.
Premium	Full home screen system with multiple living apps, custom automation, and monthly optimization.

10. Launch Roadmap

The fastest route is to build one branded proof-of-concept, then sell the same structure as a premium animated link funnel for businesses and personal brands.

Week	Focus	Deliverable
1	Define brand system and world map.	Names, app labels, stop copy, final CTA, placeholder links.
2	Create visual assets.	Home screen mockup, app icons, one causeway world background, simple portal animation.
3	Build interactive MVP.	React/Next.js page with app launcher, stop pauses, continue button, lead form.
4	Test and package offer.	Mobile QA, analytics, one-page sales page, client demo, outreach message.

First proof point to test: Do people stay longer and click more when links are presented as an interactive journey instead of a standard link page?

11. AI Builder / Developer Prompt

Use this prompt in a coding assistant or give it to a developer. It is written to keep the build simple while preserving the unique world-building concept.

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Build a mobile-first web app called Portal Machine Story Maps. The app should behave
like a premium animated link-in-bio system where the main screen is stationary and
shows a grid of applications. On desktop, the main screen should feel like a clean
computer desktop. On mobile, it should feel like a phone home screen. Do not use Apple
logos or trademarked UI assets.

At the top of the main screen, display: Portal Machine Story Maps. Include 6 app
icons: Dating, Portfolio, Company, Research, Kindred's Waitlist, and More. Each icon
should be configurable from a JSON data object.

When a user clicks an app icon, launch that app's living world. The living world is a
kinetic narrative architecture funnel. It begins with a Start button. After the user
clicks Start, animate a cause-and-effect sequence: a lever moves, a gear turns, a
bridge opens, or a portal activates. The animation should pause at each stop.

For the Kindred's Waitlist app, create these stops:
1. Social Portal - button: Visit Dating Project - link: #dating-link
2. Portfolio Gallery - button: View Portfolio - link: #portfolio-link
3. Company Lab - button: Visit Company - link: #company-link
4. Research Observatory - button: View Research - link: #research-link
5. Final Waitlist Portal - button: Join the Waitlist - link: #waitlist-link

At every stop, show the stop title, a short description, a primary action button, and
a Continue Journey button. If the user clicks Continue Journey, the animation moves to
the next stop. If the user clicks the primary button, open that link.

Use React or Next.js. Use Framer Motion or GSAP for timeline animation. Keep the MVP
lightweight. Store the app configuration, stops, copy, and links in JSON so future
clients can get their own living world without rewriting the code. Include
reduced-motion accessibility support. Track events: app_opened, start_clicked,
stop_viewed, primary_link_clicked, continue_clicked, final_cta_clicked,
waitlist_submitted.

The visual direction should be whimsical but clean: pastel colors, hand-drawn inspired
rooms, portals, gears, bridges, tiny towers, and floating architecture. The frontend
should make the experience feel magical, but the code should stay modular and simple.
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12. Production Checklist

Use this checklist to turn the concept into a real demo without drifting into unnecessary complexity.

- Choose the first 5-6 application names for the home screen.
- Write the stop labels, descriptions, CTA buttons, and placeholder links for each application.
- Create one simple visual style system: colors, line style, icon style, portal shape, room shape.
- Build one reusable app world component before designing multiple worlds.
- Make Kindred's Waitlist the first full demo because it proves your personal ecosystem.
- Use analytics from the first version to measure clicks, time on page, stop completion, and final CTA conversion.
- Package it as a productized service for restaurants, creators, entrepreneurs, local businesses, and portfolios.
- After the first client/custom build, convert repeated patterns into templates.

One-sentence sales version:

Portal Machine Story Maps gives every business a living app world that routes visitors through a story, shows their best links, and turns curiosity into clicks, bookings, orders, or waitlist signups.

Recommended next move: build the first stationary home screen and the Kindred's Waitlist world as the proof-of-concept. After that, clone the same engine into restaurant, entrepreneur, portfolio, and research templates.